hoped that this support would translate into long-term funding, but realistically expected few changes in the foreign aid program in the near future.[25]

Congressional sentiments and Treasury's concerns indeed continued to limit the prospects of a long-term aid package,[26] but a change in the foreign aid debate on Capitol Hill was potentially beneficial for India. Senator J. William Fulbright (D-AK) proposed consideration of a long-term Development Loan Fund and a focus on aiding countries economically rather than militarily.[27] Delhi's cause was further helped by the fact that India skeptics like Senator Wayne Morse (D-OR) had come around to the view that it was important to aid India—even if it remained nonaligned.[28] For FY1960, Congress approved close to $200 million. The State Department's policy planning director noted that the more favorable public and congressional climate for aid to India was likely to persist thanks to Sino-Indian differences becoming apparent.[29]

The US embassy in India continued to be concerned about Moscow's competing efforts and its intentions in India.[30] American and British officials, on their part, evaluated US attractiveness to and advantages in India versus those of the Soviet Union. They recognized that the Indian government was wary of increased Soviet political and economic influence and had taken steps to limit it. Thus, while officials thought Delhi would continue to seek Soviet aid, they also expected it to try to diversify its dependence.[31]

For the same reason, there continued to be little expectation that Delhi would align with Washington on all issues. Nonetheless, over the long run, the risks of a weak India were far greater than those of a strong, albeit nonaligned, India. At most, the administration could encourage "recognition of its community of interest with the Free World."[32] Eisenhower assured Nehru that the US did not want India to join any collective security arrangements; it just wanted Delhi not to "openly oppose [the US] on this."[33]

Indian officials, in turn, remained concerned about the political and economic climate in the US and its impact on aid for India. They were pleased that Senators Fulbright, Mike Mansfield (D-MT), and Morse were highlighting the benefits of economic aid relative to military aid.[34] But they worried when Congress nonetheless made cuts to the foreign aid program.[35]